again.

On May 30, Edmund Hillary of New Zealand and Tenzing Norkay of Nepal climbed Mount Everest and stood on its topmost point, without reporting either Abominable Snowmen or Martians. This, as I noted in my diary, completely ruined my short story "Everest," which I had written for Bea Mahaffey two months before.

5

Paperback interest was finally coming into existence in connection with my books.

There had been a bid on Pebble in the Sky a couple of years before and, for a time, I thought there was a paperback sale. Then, however, Pebble in the Sky appeared in second-serial form in the Winter 1950 issue of Two Complete Science-Adventure Books, a magazine published by the Planet people, which featured two long stories in every issue and which lasted eleven issues. (The one in which Pebble in the Sky appeared was the first issue.)

The magazine was not a very successful one and it didn't reach a huge audience, but it cost twenty-five cents, and there was no question but that it tapped the very audience that could be expected to buy a twenty-five-cent paperback. The paperback people who were going to do Pebble in the Sky therefore withdrew, and rightly so.

Bradbury told me about it, quite frankly, and said it was a miscalculation on Doubleday's part, and I said, "Oh well, we'll do better next time."

I suppose Brad was pleased that I took it philosophically, for when he had a chance to return tit for tat, he did.

Fred Pohl had introduced me to Truman (Mac) Talley in the spring of 1953. Mac was then an editor at New American Library (commonly known as NAL), and he was interested in science fiction.

Fred told me, in fact, that he would like to take an advance look at The Caves of Steel. I was only too eager to show it to him and to try to increase his interest in my novels. I thought I might be able to go to Brad and tell him, proudly, how cleverly I had arranged for paperback rights to my novels.

To be sure, Doubleday controlled the paperback rights and only Doubleday could sign a contract with a paperback house, but that seemed to me to be